

Daulat Khana

دولت خانہ

1. Basic Facts

- Correct/standard spelling: "Daulat Khana" - this is the spelling used consistently in academic sources (Catherine Asher's Architecture of Mughal India), Archnet, and official Punjab/WCLA heritage pages. "Doulat Khana" is a phonetic variant of the same name, not a different building.
- Built by: Commissioned by Emperor Jahangir (an inscription at the site describes it as the "Daulat Khana-i Jahangiri")
- Built in: 1617-18 CE
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: A walled residential courtyard functioning as the emperor's residence and as a passage connecting different parts of the Lahore palace

2. Construction Details

- Materials/form: Composed of arched chambers set around a central courtyard
- Architect: Construction supervised by Mamur Khan (also recorded as 'Abd al-Karim), an architect associated with multiple projects under both Jahangir and Shah Jahan
- Location: West of the Diwan-i-Amm, and east of the Moti Masjid

3. Historical Background

- "Daulat Khana" is the broader Mughal-administrative term for the emperor's residential quarters/palace as a whole - the same term appears at other Mughal sites (e.g. Fatehpur Sikri, Lucknow) to mean essentially "the royal residence." At Lahore Fort, the term is applied specifically to this walled courtyard commissioned by Jahangir.
- The Maktab Khana (also spelled Makatib Khana or Makateeb Khana) - a distinct Persian-style compound with pointed-arch arcades and a deep iwan (vaulted entrance hall) at the centre of each of its four sides - is documented as most likely forming part of this same wider Daulat Khana-e-Jahangiri complex, serving as an inscription/record-keeping facility for the emperor's residence, rather than being a fully separate structure elsewhere in the fort.
- Functioned primarily as a passage and residential courtyard connecting different parts of the Lahore palace complex, rather than as a ceremonial hall like the Diwan-i-Aam or Diwan-i-Khas.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The word "Daulat Khana" was used across the wider Mughal world (Lahore, Fatehpur Sikri, and later Nawabi Lucknow) simply to mean "royal residence" - Lahore Fort's Daulat Khana is one specific, named instance of a much more general Mughal architectural term.
- Its architect, Mamur Khan, was a recurring figure across multiple Jahangir- and Shah Jahan-era building projects in the fort - a reminder that a small number of master builders were responsible for much of the fort's most significant Mughal-era architecture.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Not a throne room, not a mosque, not a bedchamber - just a quiet, arched passage of a courtyard, built so that members of the royal household could move between the fort's more famous rooms without cutting through public ceremonial space, with the emperor's own record-keepers working nearby in the four-sided compound next door.

AI Heritage Revive — Lahore Fort landmark reference. Compiled from encyclopedic research report; figures marked "Not documented" are intentionally left blank rather than estimated.